

Playing chess not checkers #businessgrowth

#motivation #sucessjourney #mindset #successboost

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Executive Summary

Greg Lav uses his experience with Bloom Greens' temporary Walmart end-cap displays to illustrate the danger of prioritizing short-term wins over permanent, long-term positioning — a lesson he's now applying at Bloom Energy.

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The Bloom Greens Walmart End-Cap Story 0:00

- From **2021 through 2024**, Bloom Greens had a massive end-cap display at Walmart
 - An "end cap" is premium, high-visibility shelf space at the end of a retail aisle
 - Greg describes securing this kind of shelf space as the thing he "built his career on"
 - His ability to land impressive retail placement was a core professional identity and skill
- The critical overlooked detail: every one of those end-cap placements was a **30 to 90-day contract**
 - They were temporary by design — not permanent retail fixtures
 - Greg admits he never focused on the permanent "back aisle" shelf space during this period

The Hidden Risk of Short-Term Wins 0:22

- The consequence arrives when the retailer eventually calls and says: *"I can't have this product for the third year in a row on premier shelf space — it's time for you to go live in the back aisle for a little bit."*
 - At that point, the permanent shelf presence simply hasn't been built
 - The short-term placements did not convert into lasting retail equity
- Competitors who focus exclusively on permanent "back shelf" space are the ones who **win long-term**
 - Greg frames this as the people who will "kick your ass in the long term" — they ignore the flashy end caps and quietly build durable placement



Applying the Chess Mindset at Bloom Energy [0:45](#)

- At his current venture, **Bloom Energy**, Greg is deliberately doing both simultaneously
 - Still pursuing special/premium shelf space for short-term visibility and wins
 - But spending equal time pursuing and negotiating **10-year contracts** for permanent positioning
- The philosophy: chase short-term wins *and* prioritize long-term wins at the same time — don't sacrifice one for the other

"We're getting short-term wins, but at the same time, we're actually prioritizing the long-term wins. And that's just playing chess, not checkers."

- "Playing chess, not checkers" = thinking multiple moves ahead, valuing positional strength over immediate gains